Singapore’s Chinatown: Nation Building and Heritage Tourism in a Multiracial City

新加坡牛车水：多种族城市中的国家建构与遗产旅游

Brenda S. A. Yeoh and Lily Kong · Localities, Vol. 2 (2012), pp. 117–159

排版说明：正文按“英文原文—中文译文”交替排列，便于逐段阅读、做笔记并核对作者原本的英文表述。英文正文依据用户上传 PDF 提取，仅修复 PDF 换行、断词和版面造成的明显技术性断裂，不改写作者论点。正文中的脚注编号保留；脚注和参考文献中的书目信息不翻译，以避免人名、书名、期刊名与页码发生偏差。

Abstract

摘要

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 1

This paper focuses on the pivotal role played by the state in refashioning the Chinatown landscape as part of both nation-building and heritage tourism projects, and the ensuing cultural politics. After a brief history of the creation of Singapore’s Chinatown, the paper discusses, first, Chinatown’s place in Singapore’s post-independence nation-building project and, second, the reconfiguration of the Chinatown landscape as a tourism asset. The final section reflects on the changing politics of place as Chinatown gains legitimacy in state discourses on heritage, tourism and multiculturalism, as well as in the popular imagination as an ethnic precinct par excellence. Keywords: Ethnic Enclave, Historic District, Politics of Place, Nation-Building, Heritage Tourism

□□□□ · □□□□ **1**

本文聚焦国家在将牛车水景观重新塑造为国家建构与遗产旅游项目组成部分的过程中所发挥的关键作用，以及由此产生的文化政治。文章首先简要回顾新加坡牛车水的形成历史，随后讨论两个方面：第一，牛车水在新加坡独立后国家建构项目中的位置；第二，牛车水景观如何被重新配置为一种旅游资产。最后一部分反思地方政治的变化：随着牛车水在国家有关遗产、旅游和多元文化主义的话语中，以及在大众想象中，获得作为典型族群街区的正当性，其地方政治也随之发生变化。关键词：族群飞地、历史街区、地方政治、国家建构、遗产旅游。

Introduction

引言

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 2

Chinese living in cities beyond China have formed compact and comparatively exclusive settlements known as Chinatowns, in which they resided, worked and traded.1) Following Crissman's classic model of ideal-type Chinatown2), scholars such as William Skinner and Wang Gungwu have portrayed Chinatown as an extension of homeland practices, where principles of social organization based on descent, locality and occupation that had ordered rural life in China were transplanted to overseas urban settings. This paper focuses on the historical development of and cultural politics surrounding Singapore's Chinatown, a landscape almost two centuries old. Unlike many other examples of 'immigrant ethnic neighbourhoods' discussed in European contexts where the neighbourhood is a creation of the 'minority culture' of specific 'immigrant' or 'ethnic' groups, Singapore's Chinatown is unique in representing the cultural heritage of the dominant racial category (i.e. 'Chinese') in a multiracial population. In contrast to the urban cultural politics revolving around the way immigrant entrepreneurs capitalize on 'ethnic neighbourhoods' to offer consumption and leisure opportunities with a 'difference' in many European and North American cities, the Singapore case shows the pivotal role played by the state in refashioning the Chinatown landscape as part of both nation-building and heritage tourism projects, and the ensuing cultural politics. To put it in more theoretical terms, migrant residential concentrations in western cities have often been seen in two ways, in negative terms either as an outcome of discrimination ("ethnic marginalisation") or an unwillingness on the part of the minority group to assimilate ("ethnic separateness"), or more positively in terms of "strategic choice" on the part of the group to form a geographical base to provide ethno-specific services, strengthen social support and preserve and transmit the community's heritage, culture and values (Dunn 1998; 2007). In contradistinction, we contend that an understanding of the making of Singapore's Chinatown situates the local cultural politics not so much in terms of "marginalization"/"separateness"/"choice", but in between the postcolonial state and its citizens, as part of the larger negotiations over state-led nation-building and heritage tourism. We also argue that the cultural politics of place is not static but shifts with the emergence of new migrant enclaves as Singapore globalises and becomes porous to new streams of migrants and transients. After a brief history of the creation of Singapore's Chinatown under colonial rule, the paper discusses first, Chinatown's place in Singapore's post-independence nation-building project and, second, the reconfiguration of the Chinatown landscape as a tourism asset. This is followed by a section discussing the negotiations between the state and the people over state-led efforts to transform Chinatown. The penultimate section reflects on the changing politics of place as Chinatown gains legitimacy in state discourses on heritage, tourism and multiculturalism, as well as in the popular imagination, as an ethnic precinct par excellence, while the conclusion draws attention to the emergent politics of place beyond Chinatown in the new millennium as migrant worker enclaves gain greater visibility in the globalizing city.

生活在中国以外城市中的华人形成了紧密而相对独立的聚居区，即所谓的Chinatown（唐人街/牛车水），他们在其中居住、工作和经商。1）沿用 Crissman 关于理想型 Chinatown 的经典模型2），William Skinner、王赓武等学者把 Chinatown 描述为中国本土社会实践的延伸：原本组织中国乡村生活的血缘、地域和职业原则，被移植到了海外城市环境中。本文关注拥有近两个世纪历史的新加坡牛车水的历史发展，以及围绕它形成的文化政治。欧洲语境中讨论的许多“移民族群社区”，是由特定“移民”或“族群”群体的“少数文化”所创造的；与此不同，新加坡牛车水的独特之处在于，它代表的是一个多种族人口结构中占主导地位的种族类别——即“华人”——的文化遗产。许多欧洲和北美城市的文化政治，围绕移民企业家如何利用“族群社区”为消费和休闲提供一种“差异性”展开；相比之下，新加坡案例显示，国家在把牛车水景观重新塑造成国家建构和遗产旅游项目的一部分时发挥了关键作用，并由此引发了相应的文化政治。进一步从理论上说，西方城市中的移民居住聚集区通常有两类解释：负面看法要么把它视为歧视造成的结果（“族群边缘化”），要么视为少数群体不愿同化的结果（“族群分离”）；较为正面的看法则把它视为群体的一种“策略性选择”，即建立一个地理基地，以提供族群特定服务、加强社会支持，并保存和传递社区的遗产、文化与价值（Dunn 1998；2007）。与此不同，作者认为，要理解新加坡牛车水的形成，与其用“边缘化/分离/选择”来解释当地的文化政治，不如把它置于后殖民国家与其公民之间的关系中，把它视为围绕国家主导的国家建构和遗产旅游展开的更大范围协商的一部分。作者还指出，地方的文化政治并非静止不变；随着新加坡全球化，并向新的移民与短期流动人口开放，新的移民飞地出现，地方政治也随之发生变化。文章在简要介绍殖民统治下新加坡牛车水的形成历史之后，首先讨论牛车水在新加坡独立后国家建构项目中的位置，其次讨论牛车水景观如何被重新配置为旅游资产。随后一节考察国家与民众围绕国家主导的牛车水改造之间的协商。倒数第二节反思地方政治的变化：牛车水逐渐在国家有关遗产、旅游和多元文化主义的话语中，以及在大众想象中，获得作为典型族群街区的正当性；结论则把注意力转向新千年中牛车水之外新出现的地方政治，因为在全球化城市里，外来劳工飞地正变得越来越可见。

Colonial Chinatown: Racialised Landscape

殖民时期的牛车水：种族化景观

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 3

As elsewhere, Chinatown's demography in Singapore during the colonial period was characterized in the nineteenth and first half of the twentieth centuries by either indentured labour systems or kinship-based chain-migration of predominantly men, followed by a post-World War Two phase during which this 'bachelor society' was gradually transformed by the presence of more female migrants and family immigration.3) Largely self-organising entities, socio-political life and the provision of 'cradle-to-grave' services in these transplanted communities were anchored, to different extents in different communities, by Chinese associations based on clan, surname, dialect or provenance. Portrayed as an 'immigrant neighbourhood' or an 'ethnic enclave', Chinatown is identified as a reception area for newcomers, an agglomeration of ethnic businesses (including 'illegal' or 'immoral' practices such as drug trafficking, gambling and prostitution) serving its 'own kind', and the focal point of a well-knit community in a foreign land. Chinatown, depicted in this vein, is essentially an outpost of a foreign country, comprising a diasporic community of 'unassimilable foreigners'. Recent scholarship argues, however, that Chinatown is not just an exported structure but the product of host society reception, colonial labour policies in some instances and, racially discriminatory and discursive practices more generally. As Anderson has noted, the term "Chinatown", both as a spatial entity and an idea, was ascribed by European society.4) In Singapore, the inscription of "Chineseness" in a specific place has its roots in colonial urban planning. A few years after founding the settlement of Singapore as a British factory in 1819, Stamford Raffles appointed a town committee to mark out separate quarters for the different "native" communities, including a Chinese kampung on the south-west bank of the Singapore River to accommodate this "peculiar" and "industrious race". As with many Third World colonial cities, the idea of racial categorisation was firmly inscribed into the colonial urban landscape from the city's foundation. As colonial Singapore consolidated its position as premier entrepot of the Far East, it witnessed ever-increasing immigration of Chinese and Indians in search of livelihood and economic advancement. Chinese immigrants gravitated towards Chinatown where support structures such as clan-based accommodation, welfare institutions and the control of particular occupational niches by one's group were already well established. By the turn of the century, Chinatown occupied only about 2 sq km but contained one-third of the municipal population, over 66,000 people of which the overwhelming majority (91%) was Chinese. In the colonial imagination, Chinatown as a landscape was comprehended through multiple lenses of moral, medical and racial categories. Such images were reinforced by, and corroborated in, both scientific health surveys of the medical fraternity and the dilettante description of popular accounts. Within colonial medical discourse, Chinatown was a nursery of "dangerous infectious diseases". Among lay observers, Chinatown was often depicted as filthy and pestilential, an image conjoined with that of moral decay evidenced by gambling houses, opium dens, gaudy temples, dimly-lit brothels and the higgledy-piggledy disorder of Chinese street-life. From the colonial perspective, Chinatown as a landscape derived its identity through association with the Chinese. In turn, by objectifying the physical and moral miasma of all things Chinese, the Chinatown landscape further contributed to the making of the Chinese as a separate racial category.

与其他地方相似，殖民时期新加坡牛车水的人口结构在19世纪和20世纪上半叶主要由契约劳工制度，或以亲属关系为基础、且以男性为主的链式迁移所塑造。二战后，随着更多女性移民和家庭移民的出现，这种“单身汉社会”才逐渐发生转变。3）这些移植到海外的社区在很大程度上实行自我组织；其社会政治生活以及“从摇篮到坟墓”的各种服务，在不同社区中以不同程度依托于按照宗族、姓氏、方言或原籍地组织起来的华人社团。作为“移民社区”或“族群飞地”来描述时，Chinatown 被视为新来者的接纳区、为“自己人”服务的族群商业集中地——其中也包括贩毒、赌博和卖淫等被归为“非法”或“不道德”的活动——以及异乡中联系紧密的社区中心。按照这种描述，Chinatown 本质上仿佛是一个外国在当地的前哨，由一群“无法同化的外国人”组成的离散社群构成。不过，近期研究认为，Chinatown 并不只是从原乡移植出来的结构，它也是东道社会的接纳方式、某些情况下的殖民劳工政策，以及更普遍的种族歧视和相关话语实践共同作用的产物。正如 Anderson 所指出的，“Chinatown”无论作为空间实体还是作为一种观念，都是欧洲社会赋予的名称。4）在新加坡，把“华人性”铭刻在某个特定地方的做法，其根源在于殖民城市规划。1819年建立新加坡这一英国贸易据点数年后，Stamford Raffles 任命一个城镇委员会，为不同“土著”社群划定彼此分开的区域，其中包括在新加坡河西南岸设置一个华人甘榜，以容纳这个被称为“特殊”而“勤劳”的种族。与许多第三世界殖民城市一样，种族分类的观念从城市建立之初就被牢牢写入殖民城市景观。随着殖民地新加坡巩固其作为远东主要转口港的地位，越来越多寻求生计与经济机会的华人和印度人移入。华人移民趋向聚居牛车水，因为那里已经建立起宗族式住宿、福利机构，以及由本群体控制特定职业领域等支持结构。到世纪之交，牛车水虽然只占约2平方公里，却容纳了全市三分之一的人口，共6.6万余人，其中绝大多数（91%）为华人。在殖民想象中，牛车水这一景观是通过道德、医学和种族等多重分类视角来理解的。这些形象既受到医学界科学卫生调查的强化，也得到大众作品中业余式描述的印证。在殖民医学话语中，牛车水被视为“危险传染病”的温床；在一般观察者笔下，它又常被描绘成肮脏、疫病横行的地方，这种形象与赌博场所、鸦片烟馆、艳丽庙宇、昏暗妓院以及华人街头生活杂乱无章所象征的道德堕落联系在一起。从殖民者的角度看，牛车水这一景观因与华人相联系而获得其身份。反过来，通过把一切“华人事物”的物质与道德污浊客体化，牛车水景观又进一步参与了把华人塑造为一个独立种族类别的过程。

Chinatown and Nation-Building

牛车水与国家建构

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 4

In the early 1960s, Singapore wrested independence from the British and became a sovereign state. Within the newly-emerging state, Chinatown was no longer an exclusive Chinese enclave within a plural society under British rule but an anachronistic place name in a predominantly Chinese city. Independence, however, did not render the imagery of quintessential “Chineseness” associated with Chinatown moribund. Instead, the reservoir of colonial allusions continued to be drawn upon, reconstituted and transformed to serve new purposes within the independent state. Post-1945 Chinatown was an area occupied by dilapidated, densely-built shophouses6), a complicated mix of residential, industrial and commercial land use in close proximity. The problem of severe residential overcrowding was exacerbated by a lack of sanitation, lack of public open spaces and community services, and congested roads. Overcrowding contributed both to high land values and irregular plot sizes, discouraging redevelopment. With independence, the eradication of these problems became a priority for a state seeking to secure political legitimacy, build ideological consensus and transform the population to a disciplined industrial workforce.7) In 1966, urban renewal was accorded special recognition with the establishment of the Urban Renewal Department within the Housing and Development Board (HDB) (the post-independence successor of the Singapore Improvement Trust). The primary emphasis of urban renewal was slum clearance and comprehensive redevelopment of the Central Area of Singapore. In the same year, the Land Acquisition Act was enacted to facilitate the compulsory acquisition of land in the Central Area where buildings were largely rent-controlled and under fragmented ownership.8) Redevelopment of the Central Area included the planning and designing of public housing and amenities such as shops, markets, hawker stalls, offices and open spaces; the sale of reparcelled sites to private developers to build residential, retail or office properties; and the planning of infrastructure. Comprehensive state-initiated urban renewal was seen as the key to giving valuable but slum-ridden areas located in the heart of the city a fresh lease of life. Like the redevelopment dreams for upgrading the Dharavi settlement that Nihal Perera discusses in the context of Mumbai, Chinatown was the target of urban developers’ desire for legibility.9) Unlike Dharavi (which continues to be negotiated between social groups with different power bases and a weak state), however, Singapore’s Chinatown as a local neighbourhood was less able to resist the combined interests of private capital and a powerful state. In less than two decades, the built environment of Chinatown was dramatically redrawn along high modernist lines informed by efficiency, discipline and rationality of landuse. In the early 1960s, it was estimated that a quarter of a million people required rehousing if Chinatown were to be redeveloped. By the mid-1970s, the mosaic of low-rise shophouses which had formed the basic fabric of old Chinatown incorporated many new elements representing both public and private efforts. Demolition went in tandem with building “homes for the people” to accommodate relocated families.10) Some public housing in the form of high-rise low-cost flats which allowed efficient use of high-value land was provided within Chinatown itself in order to keep the population in the city centre. The design of the project shops and eating houses on the lower floors, wide staircases and ramps connecting the tower blocks with each other and to the neighbouring Kreta Ayer People’s Theatre and community centre signalled the state’s attempt to retain the ‘close and self-contained community living’ which had characterised cubicle-living in the past.

20世纪60年代初，新加坡摆脱英国统治并成为主权国家。在这个新生国家中，牛车水不再是英国殖民统治下多元社会中的专属华人飞地，而是在一个以华人为主的城市里显得有些时代错置的地名。然而，独立并没有使与牛车水相联系的典型“华人性”意象消亡。相反，殖民时期积累下来的这些联想继续被调用、重新组织和改造，以服务独立国家中的新目的。1945年后的牛车水由破旧且密集建造的店屋6)构成，住宅、工业和商业土地用途在狭小范围内复杂混杂。严重的居住拥挤，又因卫生设施不足、公共开放空间与社区服务缺乏以及道路拥堵而进一步恶化。拥挤既推高了地价，也形成不规则地块，从而抑制再开发。独立后，消除这些问题成为国家的优先事项，因为国家希望借此巩固政治合法性、建立意识形态共识，并把人口转化为纪律化的产业工人队伍。7）1966年，随着建屋发展局（HDB；它是独立后新加坡改良信托局的继承机构）内部成立市区重建局，城市更新获得特别重视。城市更新首先强调清除贫民窟和全面重建新加坡中央地区。同年，《土地征用法》颁布，以方便强制征收中央地区的土地；那里许多建筑受到租金管制，产权又十分分散。8）中央地区的再开发包括规划和设计公共住房，以及商店、市场、小贩摊位、办公空间和开放空间等设施；把重新划分后的地块出售给私人开发商，用于建设住宅、零售或办公物业；以及规划基础设施。国家主导的综合城市更新被视为让位于市中心、价值很高却沦为贫民区的地区重新获得生机的关键。正如 Nihal Perera 在讨论孟买 Dharavi 聚落升级时所说的那种再开发想象，牛车水也成为城市开发者追求“可读性”的对象。9）但与 Dharavi 不同——后者仍在拥有不同权力基础的社会群体与一个较弱国家之间持续协商——新加坡牛车水作为地方社区，更难抵抗私人资本与强势国家结合起来的利益。不到二十年，牛车水的建成环境就按照强调效率、纪律和土地利用理性化的高度现代主义原则被大幅重绘。20世纪60年代初，据估计，若要重建牛车水，就需要为25万人重新安置住房。到70年代中期，原本构成旧牛车水基本肌理的低层店屋拼贴中，已经加入许多由公共与私人力量共同塑造的新元素。拆除与建设“人民的家园”同步进行，以安置被搬迁的家庭。10）为了让人口继续留在市中心，牛车水本身也建设了一些高层低成本公共住房，以有效利用高价值土地。这些项目在低层设置商店和食肆，并以宽阔楼梯和坡道把塔楼彼此连接，同时通往邻近的 Kreta Ayer People’s Theatre 和社区中心；这些设计体现了国家试图保留过去“格子间式居住”所具有的那种“紧密、自足的社区生活”。

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 5

Besides accommodating public housing, land freed as a result of demolition was amalgamated and reparcelled for sale to the private sector. Private sector developments included high-rise mixed-use complexes such as the Peoples’ Park Complex, a development of three floors of eating and shopping space (formerly located in the open-air site) topped by residential flats, and the Peoples’ Park Centre, consisting of a tower block housing medium-cost apartments, podium shops and a multi-storey car park. Another example is the twenty-storey Fook Hai Building, the first experiment of its kind in Singapore where businesses affected by clearance in Chinatown joined to form a public company to undertake the mixed-use redevelopment project in a cooperative manner. These commercial, retail and residential projects were to serve as means to generate both day activities and night life in the area so as to recreate the “traditional” liveliness and atmosphere of old Chinatown. The integration of residential flats with podium shops in both public and private housing efforts was an attempt to replicate the mix of landuse, convenience and easy access to market and retail facilities which had typified the original shophouse landscape. At the same time, by segregating landuse on different specialist floors stacked on top of each other, accessibility could be disentangled from the chaotic juxtaposition of activities in the former landscape. However, the rewriting of the Chinatown palimpsest did not entail the total erasure of the amalgam of forms laid down during the pre-independence era. While certain parts of Chinatown did not escape the bludgeon of redevelopment, sufficient vestiges of the shophouse motif endured. For many years, the fate of the remaining old Chinatown landscape stood in the balance, but by the late 1970s, there were signs of a rethinking of the overall state policy pertaining to Chinatown. While this did not signify an overturning of the redevelopment juggernaut, it was symptomatic of the wider concern that transforming historically significant and culturally rich localities into an “environment of towers” would dilute the country’s heritage, an ingredient crucial to the pressing task of nation-building. Investigations into the viability of conserving Chinatown were set into motion as early as 1976, but these efforts did not bear fruit until 1986 when the Urban Redevelopment Authority (URA) announced its Conservation Master Plan, which included the preservation of substantial portions of the Chinatown landscape.

除了建设公共住房，拆除后腾出的土地还被合并、重新分块并出售给私人部门。私人开发项目包括 Peoples' Park Complex 等高层混合用途综合体：原先位于露天场地的饮食与购物空间被安排在三层商业裙房中，上面再叠加住宅；Peoples' Park Centre
则由容纳中等成本公寓的塔楼、裙房商店和多层停车场组成。另一个例子是20层的 Fook Hai Building，这是新加坡首次进行此类实验：受到牛车水清拆影响的商户联合成立一家公众公司，以合作方式推进混合用途再开发。商业、零售和住宅项目被当作同时制造白天活动和夜间生活的手段，以重现旧牛车水“传统的”热闹与氛围。无论公共还是私人住房项目，都把住宅单元与裙房商店结合起来，这是在尝试复制原有店屋景观中混合土地用途、便利性以及易于接近市场和零售设施的特点。与此同时，通过把不同土地用途分隔到上下叠置的专业楼层中，也可以把“可达性”从旧景观中各种活动混乱并置的状态中分离出来。不过，对牛车水这一“重写本”的重新书写，并不意味着把独立前留下的各种形态全部抹去。牛车水的一些部分确实没能逃过再开发的重击，但仍有足够多的店屋形态残存下来。多年来，旧牛车水剩余景观的命运一直悬而未决；但到20世纪70年代末，国家关于牛车水的总体政策已显露出重新思考的迹象。这并不意味着再开发机器被彻底逆转，而是反映出一种更广泛的担忧：如果把具有历史意义、文化丰富的地区全部改造成“塔楼环境”，就会削弱国家遗产，而遗产正是当时紧迫的国家建构任务中的重要组成部分。早在1976年，有关保存牛车水可行性的调查便已启动，但这些努力直到1986年才取得成果；当年市区重建局（URA）公布《保育总蓝图》，其中包括保存牛车水景观的大面积区域。

Chinatown and the Heritage-Enterprise Nexus

牛车水与“遗产—企业”纽带

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 6

As noted, in the immediate post-independence period, the Singapore landscape was shaped by a demolish-and-rebuild philosophy to excise urban slums and rural kampungs, to etch into the city the lineaments of technological progress and to optimise scarce land resources for economic development. However, if the first two decades of the nation's development was dictated by erasure of the past, the next two saw a more concerted attempt to recover lost memory and fashion an appropriate genealogy which would constitute the nation's legitimacy, clearly marked, signposted and concretised in the landscape. 'Remembering' emerged at a specific time and place in the nation's development, both as an inevitable condition of the cycle of progress and loss as well as a deliberate strategy of forging the nation's future. Chua argues that 'nostalgia' and a harking back to the past during the 1980s and 1990s were rooted in the wider critique of and resistance to the relentless drive towards economic development, the frenetic pace of life, high stress levels, the corruption of new-found materialism and the consequent 'industrialisation of everyday life'.11) Nostalgia is not only a construction of the past but also a condition of the present. The groundswell of public opinion in favour of the past coincided with state evaluations of the dangers of 'forgetting to remember'. In the 1980s, the governing elite noted with great apprehension the increasing westernisation of Singapore society. Though westernisation had served Singapore well in its quest for industrialisation, it had also brought in train values which were perceived to be incompatible with traditional Asian values. This unease over what Kwok calls ''the complexity of our cultural condition'' took the form of pronouncements and debates in both official and public discourse on a number of themes urging the preservation of 'Asian' and 'traditional' values and the maintenance of 'local' cultural identity and heritage.12) The perceived need to reclaim Singapore's Asian roots as a bulwark against westernisation emphasised the importance of heritage and traditions as it was argued that these provide 'the substance of social and psychological defence'.13) In this vein it was argued that heritage inscribed in the built environment is of particular significance as without 'visual landmarks', 'all other records of the past remain abstract notions, difficult to understand and link to the present'. 'It is clear therefore', continued the Report, 'that the conservation of buildings, structures and other districts which provide the sign posts from the past to the present is critical to the psyche of a nation'.14) The Urban Redevelopment Authority (URA) announced its Conservation Master Plan in December 1986. The Plan covered more than 100 hectares, including Chinatown, Kampong Glam (identified as a traditional Malay quarter), Little India, the Singapore River, Emerald Hill (a residential street distinguished for Peranakan15) architecture), and the Civic and Cultural District (a precinct comprising museums and other civic and cultural buildings).16)

如前所述，在独立初期，新加坡的景观受一种“拆除—重建”理念塑造：城市贫民窟和乡村甘榜要被清除，技术进步的线条要刻写进城市，而稀缺土地资源也要为经济发展实现最优化利用。然而，如果说国家发展的前二十年由“抹去过去”支配，那么接下来的二十年则出现了更有组织的努力：重新找回失落的记忆，并构造一条适当的谱系，使国家的合法性能够在景观中被清楚地标记、指示和具体化。“记忆”是在国家发展的特定时间和地点浮现出来的，它既是进步与失落循环中的必然结果，也是塑造国家未来的一种有意识策略。Chua 认为，20世纪80和90年代的“怀旧”与回望过去，根植于对持续追求经济发展的更广泛批评和抵制：高速而紧张的生活节奏、很高的压力水平、新兴物质主义带来的腐化，以及由此造成的“日常生活工业化”。11）怀旧不仅是对过去的建构，也是当下的一种状态。支持过去的公众舆论不断上升，恰与国家对“忘记去记忆”之危险的评估相重合。20世纪80年代，执政精英以高度忧虑的态度注意到新加坡社会日益西方化。虽然西方化曾有助于新加坡推进工业化，但它也带来了被认为与传统亚洲价值观不相容的价值。对于 Kwok 所称“我们文化处境的复杂性”的这种不安，在官方与公共话语中表现为围绕多个主题的声明和讨论：呼吁保存“亚洲的”和“传统的”价值，并维持“本地”的文化身份与遗产。12）为抵御西方化而重新寻找新加坡亚洲根源的需求，强化了遗产与传统的重要性，因为有人认为它们提供了“社会与心理防卫的实质内容”。13）按照这一思路，人们进一步主张，铭刻在建成环境中的遗产尤其重要，因为如果没有“视觉地标”，“所有其他关于过去的记录都只会停留在抽象观念层面，难以理解，也难以与现在联系起来”。该报告接着说：“因此很清楚，那些为从过去到现在提供路标的建筑、结构及其他地区，其保存对于一个国家的心理至关重要。”14）
1986年12月，市区重建局（URA）公布《保育总蓝图》。该蓝图覆盖100多公顷，包括牛车水、Kampong Glam（被认定为传统马来街区）、Little India、新加坡河、Emerald Hill（以 Peranakan15）建筑著称的住宅街区），以及 Civic and Cultural District（由博物馆及其他市政与文化建筑组成的区域）。16）

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 7

The creation of heritage landscapes not only provides the nation with a sense of historical continuity but also makes this city’s visual identity immune against the homogenising forces of modernity and globalisation. Indeed, heritage becomes more, not less, important as Singapore aspires to become a ‘cosmopolitan city’. This already began in the mid-1980s, when new economic diversification strategies were needed in response to a slowdown in manufacturing, as a consequence of the erosion of Singapore’s competitiveness in labour intensive operations. As part of the city’s strategy to carve out a specialised niche as an international business and service centre, strengthening the tourist industry played an important role. During the 1985 recession, the expansion of tourism projects, for example, was recommended by a ministerial committee as a means of reviving the flagging construction sector and absorbing the country’s high level of savings.17) The recession also came in the wake of a sharp 3.5 per cent fall in tourist arrivals in 1983. This downturn was blamed, in part, on ‘the lack of color in the increasingly antiseptic city-state’.18) In 1984, one of the three main problems for the tourism industry identified by the Tourism Task Force was the attrition of tourist attractions as Singapore has lost its ‘Oriental mystique and charm best symbolised in old buildings, traditional activities and bustling road activities’ in its effort to construct a ‘modern metropolis’.19) The recommendations of the Task Force included the conservation of cultural areas and historical sites and these were later incorporated in the Tourism Product Development Plan of 1986.20) The Plan included the expenditure of US$223 million for the redevelopment of inter alia, ethnic districts such as Chinatown, Little India and Kampong Glam. In brief, once the economic viability of preservation had been identified, state conservation policies aimed at restoring old shophouses areas such as Chinatown became a priority.21) As Zukin has noted, landscapes subject to the forces of globalisation are constantly undergoing a process of ‘creative destruction’ (borrowing Schumpeter’s term) whereby

遗产景观的创造不仅为国家提供历史连续感，也使这座城市的视觉身份能够抵抗现代性与全球化的同质化力量。事实上，随着新加坡希望成为一座“世界都会”，遗产不是变得更不重要，反而更加重要。这一趋势在20世纪80年代中期就已开始：随着新加坡在劳动密集型产业中的竞争力下降，制造业增速放缓，因此需要新的经济多元化策略。作为城市把自身塑造成国际商业与服务中心这一专业化定位的一部分，加强旅游业发挥了重要作用。例如，在1985年经济衰退期间，一个部长级委员会就建议扩大旅游项目，以复苏疲弱的建筑业并吸收国内较高水平的储蓄。17）此次衰退之前，1983年的游客入境人数还曾急剧下降3.5%。人们把这一低迷部分归咎于“这个越来越像无菌环境的城市国家缺少色彩”。18）1984年，旅游专责小组认定旅游业面临三项主要问题，其中之一就是旅游吸引物不断流失：新加坡在建设“现代大都会”的努力中，已经失去了“最能由旧建筑、传统活动和热闹街头活动所象征的东方神秘感与魅力”。19）

专责小组的建议包括保护文化区域和历史遗址，这些内容后来被纳入1986年的《旅游产品发展计划》。20）该计划提出投入2.23亿美元，重新开发包括牛车水、小印度和甘榜格南在内的族群街区。简言之，一旦遗产保存的经济可行性得到确认，国家保育政策便把修复牛车水等旧店屋区列为优先事项。21）正如 Zukin 所指出的，受到全球化力量影响的景观，会持续经历一种“创造性破坏”（借用 Schumpeter 的术语）的过程，在这个过程中——

the ‘longevity’ and ‘cultural layers’ of the landscape are constantly fragmented, reworked and recycled in tandem with market forces.22) As Singapore globalises, its heritage landscapes, as marketable landscapes for a global audience, become subject to further annihilation and re-invention. The corporatisation of urban space in the name of global competition and consumption that Mike Douglass23) discusses did not just create new mega-projects such as large shopping, leisure and entertainment complexes, simulacra designs and superlative buildings but also transformed a selection of older localities such as historically and culturally significant areas that can serve to differentiate globalising cities from one another and help sharpen their competitive edge. The transformation of the city into a ‘corporate globopolis’ also requires the facilitating and managing role of the state.24) In preparation for the new millennium, Tourism 21, a new national tourism planning exercise mounted in 1996 charted the way for a further reconfiguration of heritage and cultural spaces from inward-looking “Instant Asia” to a global-looking “New Asia”.25) In Tourism 21, the Singapore Tourism Board (STB) recommended 11 zones of ‘thematic development’ ranging from ‘Ethnic Singapore’, the ‘Mall of Singapore’ to ‘Rustic Charm’. As one of the ‘Historic Districts’ (in the Urban Conservation Master Plan) and ‘Ethnic Quarters’ (themed under the ‘Ethnic Singapore’ thematic zone under Tourism 21), Chinatown26) was accorded high priority in the state’s creation of heritage landscapes. As envisioned by the new agenda, traditional buildings in Chinatown’s shophouse landscape were no longer viewed as obsolete structures incompatible with the image of a modern, dynamic city. Instead, shophouses ‘create a sense of human scale, rhythm and charm not found in much of our modern architecture’, providing relief from ‘the monotony of a high-rise environment’.27) Traditional Chinatown is no longer the territorial domain of a community of Chinese in decline but is elevated to national importance as a civic asset, ‘a common bond place’ for ‘Singaporeans living in outlying new towns’.28) Conserving Chinatown as a veritable repository of tradition, history and culture can thus be understood as having the sociopolitical purpose of binding Singaporeans to place, to the city, and ultimately and vicariously, to the ‘nation’ by rendering heritage in material form. Chinatown, alongside other ‘ethnic quarters’, is also central to the state's attempt to bolster the tourism industry by selling Singapore as first ‘Instant Asia’, then ‘New Asia’, ‘a city of many colours and contrasts, cultures and cuisines’.29) While the colonial state had racialised the Chinatown landscape using negative Chinese stereotypes, the contemporary state has inverted this image and capitalised on what it deems to be positive Chinese cultural traits. Chinatown is now identified with the pioneering spirit and enterprise of early Chinese immigrants to Singapore and showcased as a distinctively Chinese cultural area. In order to harness market forces to heritage conservation, rent control was lifted in 1988/89 under the Controlled Premises (Special Provisions) Act to allow for the recovery of premises for redevelopment in accordance with conservation guidelines.30) To encourage private owners to restore their buildings, the URA made available various incentives such as waiving development charges, eliminating car parking requirements and assisting owners needing to relocate their old-single person tenants. At the same time, restoration has had to adhere to stringent guidelines pertaining to the facade design, internal structure, signage, materials used and any other forms of alteration or addition with a view to retaining historical consistency and the architectural distinctiveness of the place. Following these guidelines, property owners and developers have seized the opportunity to evict former tenants, refurbish the visual and structural quality of shophouse units including their wall openings, five-foot ways, columns, pilasters, window shutters, balconies and ornamentation, and sell them on the market as ‘heritage’ properties of particular interest to retailers wishing to ‘capture the shopping and gourmet traffic right in the traditional retail heart of Singapore’.31) In determining the type of building use, approved trades usually those identified as symbolic of Chinese tradition32)

——景观的“持久性”和“文化层累”会随着市场力量不断被切割、重组与循环利用。22）

随着新加坡全球化，其遗产景观作为面向全球受众、可以被市场化的景观，也进一步经历消解和再创造。Mike Douglass23）所讨论的、以全球竞争和消费为名义进行的城市空间公司化，不只制造了大型购物、休闲与娱乐综合体、拟像式设计和追求“世界之最”的建筑等超级项目；它也改造了一批更老的地方，尤其是那些具有历史和文化意义、能够帮助全球化城市彼此区分并增强竞争优势的区域。把城市转变为“企业化的全球都市（corporate globopolis）”同样需要国家发挥促进与管理作用。24）

为迎接新千年，1996年启动的新一轮全国旅游规划“Tourism 21”为遗产与文化空间的进一步重构制定方向：从面向内部的“Instant Asia”转向面向全球的“New Asia”。25）在 Tourism 21 中，新加坡旅游局（STB）提出11个“主题发展”区域，包括“Ethnic Singapore”“Mall of Singapore”和“Rustic Charm”等。牛车水26)既是《城市保育总蓝图》中的“历史街区”，又是 Tourism 21 中“Ethnic Singapore”主题区之下的“族群街区”，因此在国家创造遗产景观的过程中被赋予很高优先级。按照这一新议程，牛车水店屋景观中的传统建筑不再被视为与现代、充满活力城市形象不相容的过时结构。相反，店屋被认为“创造出我们许多现代建筑中没有的人性尺度、节奏和魅力”，并可缓解“高层环境的单调”。27）传统牛车水也不再只是一个日渐衰落的华人社区的领地，而是被提升到国家层面的重要性，成为一种公共资产，是供“居住在外围新镇的新加坡人”共享的“共同纽带之地”。28）因此，把牛车水保存为真正的传统、历史与文化储藏库，可以理解为具有社会政治目的：通过把遗产转化为物质形式，把新加坡人连接到地方、连接到城市，并最终间接连接到“国家”。牛车水和其他“族群街区”也处于国家振兴旅游业努力的核心：新加坡先被包装为“Instant Asia”，随后又成为“New Asia”——“一座拥有多种色彩与对比、多种文化与饮食的城市”。29）殖民国家曾用负面的华人刻板印象把牛车水景观种族化；当代国家则反转了这一形象，并利用其认定的正面华人文化特征。牛车水如今与早期华人移民到新加坡时的开拓精神和企业精神相联系，并作为一个具有鲜明华人特色的文化区域被展示。为了利用市场力量推动遗产保育，1988/89年根据《受管制房产（特别规定）法》取消租金管制，使业主能够收回房产，按照保育准则进行再开发。30）为鼓励私人业主修复建筑，URA 提供多种优惠，例如免除发展费、取消停车位要求，并协助需要安置原有单身老年租户的业主。与此同时，修复工作必须遵循有关立面设计、内部结构、招牌、所用材料以及其他任何改动或增建的严格准则，以维持历史一致性和地方独特的建筑特色。遵循这些准则，业主和开发商抓住机会驱逐原有租户，翻新店屋单元的视觉与结构品质，包括墙体开口、五脚基、柱子、壁柱、窗板、阳台和装饰，并把这些建筑作为“遗产”物业投入市场，特别吸引那些希望“就在新加坡传统零售中心捕捉购物与美食人流”的零售商。31）

在决定建筑用途时，通常会鼓励获准的行业——也就是那些被认定为象征华人传统的行业32)——

are encouraged while certain pollutive or incompatible trades33) are proscribed.34) Within these broad parameters, however, URA's underlying philosophy stresses that market forces should be left to decide what types of trades exist in conservation areas as successful purchasers of conserved buildings have to make economic returns in order to continue to restore and maintain them. Thus, while meticulous attention is paid to preserving buildings and other structures 'for the past they represent', lifestyles and trades are left to the vagaries of free competition.35) The 1990s saw yet another round of revitalization of the Chinatown landscape. In re-inventing Chinatown in line with the 'new Asia' vision, the STB unveiled a S$97.5 million plan to 'revitalise' and 'enhance the Chinatown experience'. The proposed 'facelift' aimed 'to bring out the full flavour of the place's sights, sounds and smells' and included an interpretative centre to provide a 'gateway' for visitors entering Chinatown; a new theatre for wayang (Chinese opera) performances; street performances from puppet-making demonstrations to martial arts shows; five 'themed' gardens; a food street with open-air cooking and dining; and a new market square selling fresh produce.36) This latest strategy draws heavily on the idea of 'theming' and the creation of 'narratives', or 'storylines which connect places and experiences in visitors' minds out of the raw material of local history'.37) The key principle is to represent the history of the place as a linearised history, an 'ideal geneaology'. STB, for example, makes it clear that 'the final product [after being repackaged as a single themed narrative] should enable any visitor, whether in a packaged tour or in a free and independent format, to understand how and why Chinatown came to be covering for example the Chinese diaspora, Sir Stamford Raffles' town plan which led to the creation of ethnic zones in Singapore, the trades of yesteryears, present conservation efforts and future developments'.38) The history of Chinatown, as mapped onto both 'real' (on the ground) and 'representational' landscapes (on brochures, maps, storyboards and tourist guides) is yet another version of the history of the nation as a unidirectional march of progress, moving inexorably from the past to the present and into the future. Like urban renewal before it, the incessant process of reworking the Chinatown landscape through urban conservation and subsequent 'facelifts' is state-driven, conceived as part of the need to refurbish the built environment as a means to enhance heritage tourism assets as well as to serve socio-political purposes of forging national identity.

——而某些污染性行业或被认为不相容的行业33)则被禁止。34）不过，在这些宽泛限制之内，URA 的基本理念强调，应让市场力量决定保育区中究竟存在什么类型的行业，因为成功购得保育建筑的人必须取得经济回报，才能继续修复和维护这些建筑。因此，虽然人们极其细致地保存建筑和其他结构，“因为它们代表过去”，生活方式和行业却被交给自由竞争的变动来决定。35）

20世纪90年代，牛车水景观又经历了一轮新的“复兴”。为了按照“New Asia”的愿景重新发明牛车水，STB 公布一项9750万新元的计划，以“振兴”并“提升牛车水体验”。这次拟议中的“翻新”旨在“充分展现这个地方的所见、所闻和气味”，其中包括：建设一个解说中心，作为游客进入牛车水的“门户”；兴建一座用于 wayang（华人戏曲）演出的新剧场；安排从木偶制作示范到武术表演的街头演出；设置五个“主题”花园；建设可露天烹饪和用餐的美食街；以及设立销售新鲜农产品的新市场广场。36）这一最新策略大量借鉴“主题化”和创造“叙事”的思想，也就是从地方历史的原材料中提炼出“在游客头脑中把地点和体验连接起来的故事线”。37）其中的关键原则，是把地方历史表现为一条线性化的历史，一种“理想谱系”。例如，STB 明确表示：“最终产品［即被重新包装成一个统一的主题叙事之后］应使任何游客——无论参加旅行团还是自由独立旅行——都能够理解 Chinatown 是如何以及为何形成的，例如其中应涵盖华人离散、Sir Stamford Raffles 的城镇规划（它导致新加坡形成族群分区）、过去的行业、当前的保育工作以及未来的发展。”38）牛车水的历史，无论被绘制到“真实”的地面景观中，还是被绘制到“表征性”的景观中——如宣传册、地图、故事板和旅游指南——都再次成为国家历史的一种版本：国家沿着单向的进步道路，从过去不可阻挡地走向现在，并进入未来。与此前的城市更新一样，通过城市保育以及后续“翻新”不断重做牛车水景观的过程依然由国家驱动；它既被视为整修建成环境、提升遗产旅游资产的需要，也服务于塑造国家认同这一社会政治目的。

The Muted Politics of Place in the Making of Chinatown

牛车水塑造过程中被弱化的地方政治

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 10

State initiatives in making Chinatown the centrepiece in urban conservation and heritage tourism projects in the 1980s and 1990s did not go entirely unchallenged. Local reactions, particularly from long-time residents, have not all been positive, with some lamenting the over-commercialisation and the privileging of tourism in the reworking of the landscape. Others have expressed concern that the strategies of adaptive reuse and the theming of the landscape have created an inauthentic “shell” with no “soul”.39) In the 1990s, the Singapore Heritage Society, a small local interest group which aims to promote heritage consciousness, critiqued the STB for turning Chinatown into an “ethnic theme park” using “the simplistic formula of capitalist profit criteria” and urged instead that festival activities, residential living and everyday lived culture should be brought back to Chinatown if the place is to regain its vibrancy and meaning for Singaporeans as well as tourists.40) Critics raised a number of issues of contention, including: the superficiality of delineating sub-districts as this “wrenches the place out of context and ‘frames’ it for purposes of easier marketing for tourists” and instead conceiving of Chinatown as “a landscape dotted with critical nodes”; STB’s plan imposed sharp boundaries on Chinatown in artificial ways the “Mandarinised Chinese” version of Chinatown rather than the diversity of dialect groups and trades, as well as the multi-ethnicity of Malay and Indian residents, businesses and places of worship the “stage management and artifice” of the new theatre complex, Chinatown Interpretive Centre and themed streets with “colour-coded street signs, street lamps, street furniture and free-standing story-boards” and instead bringing back the “sensory experience” of Chinatown through “native elements” such as wayangs, pasar malams, festival markets, the marking and opening up of houses “where a notorious criminal or wealthy towkay once stayed, [or where] a famous club or brothel or lodging for the first labour trade” were once located, and “loud” signs displayed by shophouses; and the gentrification of Chinatown to draw people back through zoning land parcels for new residential developments and hotels and instead building low-cost, medium-rise HDB housing and giving priority to “families of hawkers in the area and to single-person old folk units for [the] exisiting aged population there”41). In contrast to the above views, for the Chinatown Business Association, the remaking of Chinatown as a tourist landscape has not gone far enough. For example, without affordable hotel space in close proximity, stimulating night traffic presents a challenge. Conversely, given Singapore’s weather, the food street is not viable during the day. These challenges for the business community prompt a counter-narrative in which more collaborative efforts between state and capital are sought to enhance business opportunities.

20世纪80和90年代，国家把牛车水塑造成城市保育与遗产旅游项目核心的行动，并非完全没有受到挑战。地方上的反应，尤其是长期居民的反应，并不都很积极：一些人感叹景观重塑中过度商业化，并把旅游置于优先地位；另一些人则担心，适应性再利用和景观主题化的策略制造出了一个缺乏真实性、“有壳无魂”的牛车水。39）20世纪90年代，旨在提升遗产意识的小型地方利益团体 Singapore Heritage Society 批评 STB 使用“资本主义利润标准的简单公式”，把牛车水变成一个“族群主题公园”；该组织主张，如果要让这个地方重新获得活力，并同时对新加坡人和游客具有意义，就应该把节庆活动、居民生活和日常生活文化带回牛车水。40）批评者提出了一系列争议点，其中包括：把牛车水划分成不同子区的做法过于表面化，因为这会“把这个地方从其语境中强行抽离出来，并为了更方便向游客营销而给它‘装框’”；与其如此，不如把牛车水理解为“一处散布着关键节点的景观”。批评者还认为，STB 的规划以人为方式给牛车水划定了清晰而僵硬的边界；它呈现的是一个“华语化的华人”版本的牛车水，而不是不同方言群体和行业的多样性，也忽略了马来人与印度居民、企业和宗教场所所体现的多族群性；新剧场综合体、Chinatown Interpretive Centre 以及主题化街道——配有“颜色编码的街道标志、路灯、街道家具和独立故事板”——体现出过强的“舞台管理和人为造作”。批评者主张，应通过“本土元素”恢复牛车水的“感官体验”，例如 wayang、pasar malam、节庆市场，对“某个臭名昭著的罪犯或富有 towkay 曾经住过的房屋，［或］曾作为著名会所、妓院或早期劳工贸易住宿处”的建筑进行标记并开放，以及恢复店屋上“醒目”的招牌。另一个争议是：为了把人重新吸引回来，规划把土地划给新住宅开发项目和酒店，从而造成牛车水绅士化；批评者则建议兴建低成本、中层的 HDB 住房，并优先分配给“本区小贩家庭，以及为［现有］老年人口设置的单人老人住房”。41）与上述意见相反，牛车水商联会认为，把牛车水改造成旅游景观的程度还不够。例如，附近缺少价格可负担的酒店空间，使刺激夜间人流面临困难；反过来，由于新加坡的天气条件，美食街在白天也难以运营。这些商业界面对的挑战催生了另一种叙事：他们希望国家与资本展开更多合作，共同扩大商业机会。

In the last decade, the redevelopment of Chinatown proceeded more or less in accordance with STB's plans. Given the proximity of Chinatown to the Central Business District, it soon became evident that, between the pulls of 'heritage' and 'enterprise', Chinatown's redevelopment tilted more and more towards commercialisation. In 2005, for example the Minister for National Development Mah Bow Tan announced revised guidelines that would allow bars, pubs and health centres on the upper floors of the shophouses in Chinatown, even though these were still ruled out for the Historic Districts of Kampong Glam and Little India.42) A month later, the Telok Ayer area of Chinatown was taken off URA's Historic Districts list to liberate the area from restrictive policies banning offices from the ground floor of shophouses as "the area has evolved and become more suited to small businesses and office set-ups".43) Zoned for commercial use, conservation shophouses in Telok Ayer soon became popular with creative companies such as advertising, design, financial and professional services firms seeking alternative commercial space amidst tight office supply and a surge in office rents in the city.44) Gentrification has become the underlying rationale for redevelopment, as seen in the "extreme makeover" of the iconic Majestic Hotel from a "creaky, cranky septuagenarian" into a boutique hotel "combining a hip design sense with a sympathetic nod to its glory days of old"45); the upgrading of Chinatown Square Central, a cluster of conserved shophouses and a 15-storey office block, into an "upmarket complex featuring more bars, live music pubs and shops"46); the cleaning up of sleaze in cobble-stoned Duxton Hill and its "rebirth" as a conservation shophouse neighbourhood with high-end restaurants and cafes47); and the planned multibillion-dollar "glitzy revamp" of Tanjong Pagar, transforming "dodgy bars and seedy karaoke pubs" into "the next waterfront city" with "high-rise condominiums, glitzy hotels and plush offices"48) . Protest against the increasing commercialisation of the heritage landscape in different parts of Chinatown has been largely muted, surfacing mainly in the form of the occasional murmur in the daily press: Growing up in Chinatown, I saw how the life and soul of the area were taken away and reduced to what many see today a tourist trap.... I do not deny that many buildings in Chinatown have been preserved, ... but for whom and to what extent? Were our pre-war houses painted in multi-colours like you see today? Did they house mostly bars, pubs and restaurants? Did the shopkeepers sell keychains, T-shirts and CDs? Is it not an irony that we spend money telling the world that we are 'Uniquely Singapore' yet we keep on destroying what is uniquely Singaporean?49) Alongside nostalgic voices against commercialisation, other views, more appreciative or tolerant of the difference afforded in living in conservation areas subject to the countervailing pulls of heritage and enterprise, have emerged. A young resident of Duxton Hill remarked, Some friends have teased me about the dodginess of the area, but I personally find it exciting. In more enthusiastic moments, I have even dubbed my neighbourhood Singapore's answer to the East Village in New York City. Cheek by jowl in the terraced shophouses, the seedy bars co-exist with bridal studios, expensive restaurants, gay clubs and a Christian theology school an eclectic mix that is a shining example of how disparate factions can live in harmony.50) Others dismiss complaints about Chinatown's sanitised artifice, pointing instead to appreciating Chinatown as a work-in-progress, and for the diversity it celebrates, including the combination of different kinds of ethnic heritage that makes the place unique: The other notable thing about Singapore's Chinatown it's not just about Chinese people. True, during the festival frenzy of Chinese New Year, ... it's hard to see the forest for the faux cherry blossom trees. Chinatown seems to be all about red and gold baubles, pots of lime bushes and pussy willow, as well as scores of stalls flogging bak kwa, chicken floss, pineapple tarts, love letters,

□□□□ · □□□□ **11**

在此前十年中，牛车水的再开发大体按照 STB 的计划推进。由于牛车水邻近中央商务区，很快就可以看出，在“遗产”与“企业/商业”两种拉力之间，牛车水的再开发越来越偏向商业化。例如，2005年，国家发展部长 Mah Bow Tan 宣布修订准则，允许酒吧、酒馆和健康中心进入牛车水店屋的上层楼面，尽管这些用途在 Kampong Glam 和 Little India 的历史街区仍然不被允许。42）一个月后，牛车水的 Telok Ayer 地区被从 URA 的“历史街区”名单中移除，从而摆脱禁止店屋底层设置办公室的限制性政策，因为“该地区已经发生演变，更适合小型企业和办公用途”。43）在商业用途分区之下，Telok Ayer 的保育店屋很快受到创意企业欢迎；在全市办公空间供应紧张、租金急升之际，广告、设计、金融和专业服务公司都把这里作为替代性商业空间。44）绅士化逐渐成为再开发背后的基本逻辑，许多例子都体现了这一点：标志性的 Majestic Hotel 经历“极端改造”，从一个“吱呀作响、脾气古怪的七旬老人”变成精品酒店，并“把时髦设计感与对昔日辉煌的体贴致意结合起来”45）；Chinatown Square Central——由一组保育店屋与一栋15层办公楼组成——被升级成“拥有更多酒吧、现场音乐酒馆和商店的高档综合体”46）；铺着石板路、过去带有色情与灰色产业色彩的 Duxton Hill
被“清理”，并“重生”为一个拥有高端餐厅和咖啡馆的保育店屋社区47）；另有耗资数十亿、计划中的 Tanjong Pagar“华丽翻新”，希望把“可疑酒吧与低俗卡拉OK酒馆”变成“下一个滨水城市”，配有“高层公寓、华丽酒店和豪华办公楼”。48）针对牛车水不同区域遗产景观日益商业化的抗议总体相当微弱，主要偶尔以日报上的抱怨形式出现：“我在牛车水长大，亲眼看到这里的生活和灵魂怎样被带走，最后变成许多人今天眼中的旅游陷阱……我并不否认牛车水的许多建筑得到了保存……但它们究竟是为谁保存，又保存到了什么程度？我们战前的房屋过去会像今天这样刷成多种颜色吗？它们过去主要是酒吧、酒馆和餐厅吗？店主过去会卖钥匙扣、T恤和CD吗？我们花钱向世界宣传自己‘Uniquely Singapore’，与此同时却不断摧毁真正具有新加坡独特性的东西，这难道不是一种讽刺吗？”49）与这些反对商业化、带有怀旧色彩的声音并存的，还有另一类看法：他们更欣赏或更能容忍居住在保育区所具有的差异性，接受这些地区受到遗产与商业两股相反力量共同拉扯。一位年轻的 Duxton Hill 居民说：“有些朋友取笑我这里有点可疑，但我个人觉得它很刺激。兴致高的时候，我甚至把我的社区称为新加坡版的纽约 East Village。在一排排紧挨着的排屋式店屋里，低俗酒吧与婚纱店、高价餐厅、同性恋俱乐部以及一所基督教神学院并存；这种兼收并蓄的混合，正是彼此差异巨大的群体如何和谐共处的鲜明例子。”50）还有人不认同对牛车水“被消毒式的人为造作”的抱怨，反而主张把牛车水看作一个仍在形成中的作品，并欣赏它所展现的多样性，包括不同类型族群遗产的结合，而正是这种结合使这个地方独具特色：“关于新加坡牛车水，另一个值得注意的地方是——它不只属于华人。确实，在春节节庆狂潮期间……你很难透过那些假樱花树看清整个景象。牛车水似乎全是红色和金色装饰、金桔盆栽和银柳，还有成排摊位在卖肉干、鸡肉松、黄梨挞、love letters,

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 12

freshly-minted hong bao and rabbit-shaped balloons.... But even from its early days, Chinatown was home to a significant number of ethnic Indians or, more specifically, Hindus and Indian Muslims. There’s a Temple Street in Chinatown, named after the Sri Mariamman Temple, the oldest Hindu temple in Singapore, as well as a Mosque Street, named after the Masjid Jamae. To imagine Singapore’s Chinatown without the Sri Mariamman or the Jamae would be like imagining one’s body without a heart or a lung impossible.51)

□□□□ · □□□□ **12**

刚印好的红包和兔子形气球……但即使从早期开始，牛车水也居住着数量可观的印度族群，更具体说，包括印度教徒和印度穆斯林。牛车水有一条 Temple Street，它以新加坡最古老的印度教寺庙 Sri Mariamman Temple 命名；也有一条 Mosque Street，以 Masjid Jamae 命名。想象一个没有 Sri Mariamman 或 Jamae 的新加坡牛车水，就像想象人的身体没有心脏或肺一样——是不可能的。”51）

Singapore-Style Multiracialism and Chinatown’s Legitimacy

新加坡式多种族主义与牛车水的正当性

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 13

A product of colonial “race/space” policies, Singapore’s Chinatown has continued to be reinscribed with new forms of legitimacy as it evolves in postcolonial times. Save for the early independence period when Chinatown was threatened with erasure as a result of the quest to modernize the city-state, the precinct has been accorded a secure and generally uncontested place in national and popular imageries of the Singapore self. In the state’s visions and plans to develop national agendas in the areas of heritage, national identity and tourism, Chinatown features prominently as a pivotal site of interest. While there were alternative visions for the conservation of Chinatown as well as concern over the ‘heritagising’ of the landscape to minister to the needs of tourism, none of these dissenting voices mostly of a disparate rather than organized nature denied Chinatown a place of legitimacy in Singapore’s past, present or future. This is partly because of the state’s multiracial strategy to ensure ‘even-handedness’ in conserving and enhancing historical districts identified as the cultural hearths of different communities: while the conservation and development of Chinatown led the way, Little India52) and Kampong Glam (the traditional Malay quarter)53) were also accorded attention, resources and status as ‘Historic Districts’ alongside Chinatown. Singapore-style multiracialism is based on the formula of four ‘separate’ but ‘equal’ races in a nation of ‘one people’. The philosophy propounds the need to submerge ethnic identity to the larger purposes of nation-building and national identity construction while at the same time provides space for each of the four founding ethnic groups Chinese, Malay, Indian and ‘Other’ (CMIO for short) to promote, valorise and reclaim ethnic links and identity. This form of multiculturalism continues colonial classificatory schemas drawn upon under British rule and underlies ethnic policies governing inter- and intra-ethnic relations in different spheres of life. It is also possible that when landscapes such as Chinatown become ‘naturalised’ as part of the everyday, its ideological content becomes masked and rendered innocuous.54) Certainly, the politics of place around Chinatown as a legitimate site of Chinese ethnicity has been far more muted compared to ethnically based politics around issues such as language and the role of ethnic organizations.55) As an ‘ethnic’ place of leisure and consumption, Chinatown testifies to and reproduces a version of multiculturalism based on consumerism (i.e. taste and preferences) as well as symbolic representation rather than social contracts (and which in fact may mask the lack of robust social relationships threaded into the making of Singapore-style multiculturalism).56) This is not to suggest that there are no other kinds of contestations in Chinatown. Comaroff, for example, argues that Singapore’s Chinatown is constructed as a state landscape that renders certain subjects to the margins of society and that at the same time, it becomes ‘open to powerful new forms of contestation that evade the techniques of a regime of “biopower”’.57) Chinatown’s place in the popular imagination is also secure. A recent survey on heritage awareness among Singaporeans show that not only did an overwhelming majority favour the idea of heritage preservation in Singapore for current and future generations, they gave the highest level of priority to the nation’s historic and cultural districts such as Chinatown (compared, for example, to museums or natural sites).58) While a large minority were critical of the over-commercialisation of heritage preservation in Singapore, it is also clear that visitorship figures (for the primary purpose of appreciating history and heritage) were the highest for historic districts such as Chinatown.59) During key Chinese festive periods such as the Lunar New Year, Chinatown is clearly the site where locals converge to consume ‘authentic’ Chineseness

作为殖民“种族/空间”政策的产物，新加坡牛车水在后殖民时期的发展中不断被重新赋予新的正当性。除独立初期因城市国家追求现代化而一度面临被抹除的威胁之外，牛车水在国家层面和大众层面对“新加坡自我”的想象中，一直拥有稳固、总体上很少受质疑的位置。在国家围绕遗产、国家认同与旅游制定愿景和国家议程时，牛车水始终作为关键地点受到高度重视。虽然社会上存在其他牛车水保育设想，也有人担忧为了服务旅游需要而把景观“遗产化”，但这些异议大多分散而非有组织，并没有否认牛车水在新加坡过去、现在或未来中的正当位置。这部分源于国家的多种族策略：在保护和提升被认定为不同社群文化核心的历史街区时，要确保一种“公平对待”。牛车水的保育和开发虽然走在前面，Little India52）与 Kampong Glam（传统马来街区）53）也同样获得关注、资源，并与牛车水一起取得“历史街区”的地位。新加坡式多种族主义建立在这样一个公式上：一个“一个人民”的国家，由四个彼此“分立”但“平等”的种族构成。这一理念一方面主张把族群身份置于国家建构和国家认同塑造这一更大目标之下，另一方面也为四个创始族群——华人、马来人、印度人和“其他”（简称 CMIO）——提供空间，使它们能够推广、肯定并重新认领自身的族群联系与身份。这种多元文化主义延续了英国统治时期沿用的殖民分类框架，并成为不同生活领域中治理族群内部与族群之间关系的族群政策基础。也有可能，当牛车水这样的景观作为日常生活的一部分被“自然化”之后，其意识形态内容会被遮蔽，并显得无害。54）的确，与语言问题或族群组织角色等以族群为基础的政治争论相比，围绕牛车水作为一个具有正当性的华人族群空间所展开的地方政治，要微弱得多。55）作为一个用于休闲和消费的“族群”地方，牛车水证明并复制了新加坡式多元文化主义的一个版本：它更多建立在消费主义（即品味与偏好）以及象征性再现之上，而非社会契约之上；事实上，这甚至可能掩盖新加坡式多元文化主义在形成过程中缺乏稳固社会关系的问题。56）这并不是说牛车水完全不存在其他类型的争议。例如，Comaroff 认为，新加坡牛车水被建构为一种国家景观，使某些主体被推向社会边缘；与此同时，它也“向强大的新型争议形式开放，而这些争议能够避开‘生命权力（biopower）’体制的技术”。57）牛车水在大众想象中的位置同样十分稳固。一项近期关于新加坡人遗产意识的调查显示，压倒性多数不仅赞成为当代与未来世代保存新加坡遗产，而且还把牛车水这样的国家历史文化街区列为最高优先级——高于例如博物馆或自然遗址。58）虽然有相当大一部分人批评新加坡的遗产保护过度商业化，但从以欣赏历史和遗产为主要目的的到访人数看，牛车水这类历史街区仍然最高。59）在农历新年等华人重要节日期间，牛车水显然是本地人聚集起来消费“正宗华人性”的地方——

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 14

for example, while essential new year goodies such as barbecued sweet meats can be found in almost every regional shopping mall or neighbourhood shopping centre, long queues still form without fail outside well-known Chinatown shops selling these traditional products when the new year approaches. Clearly, Singaporeans do not hesitate to converge in Chinatown during key Chinese festive periods such as the Lunar New Year, to experience and enjoy a certain ambience. In partnership with the Chinatown Business Association and the local community organizations, the authorities have promoted Chinatown as the locus of Chinese New Year by locating the main festive celebration in Chinatown, as seen in the promotion for 2008's Chinese New Year: From 19 Jan to 6 Feb Chinatown will be transformed into a fairyland of light and colour with spectacular overarching decorations lining the streets. [At the] same time the festive street bazaar will be waiting offering all the traditional Chinese New Year goodies such as waxed duck, barbecued sweet meats, assorted cookies and other new year accessories. This makes it the 'must visit' place for Chinese, locals and tourists to soak in the festive atmosphere. On the eve of Chinese New Year (6 Feb) the countdown to the Year of the Rat gets underway with thousands of revellers partying all night long.60) In 2009 and again in 2010, more than 2 million people visited Chinatown during the Chinese New Year festivities. Indeed, tourism has recently been booming in Singapore (over 11.6 million visitors in 2010, or more than twice its population) and of the free access tourist destinations in Singapore, Chinatown numbers in the top three (along with Orchard Road, Singapore's shopping thoroughfare and the historic district of Little India).61) Of interest is the fact that while Chinatown remains popular with western tourists (particularly those from Italy, Germany, the UK and France in 2009), it is also becoming a major magnet for the rapidly growing numbers of tourists from China, Taiwan and Hong Kong.62) As a tourism market, China has grown in importance very rapidly and has become in recent years Singapore's second largest visitor-generating market; the first millionth Chinese visitor milestone was recorded on 19 December 2006.63) In short, Singapore's Chinatown continues to hold its own as an object of the tourist gaze, even with the Chinese dominance of tourist numbers.

——例如，虽然肉干等必备年货几乎在每一家区域性购物中心或社区商场都可以买到，但临近新年时，出售这些传统食品的牛车水知名商店门前仍然必定排起长队。很明显，新加坡人在农历新年等重要华人节日期间并不会犹豫前往牛车水，以体验和享受某种特定氛围。政府当局与牛车水商联会及本地社区组织合作，通过把主要春节庆祝活动安排在牛车水来强化其作为春节中心的地位。2008年春节的宣传就是一个例子：“从1月19日至2月6日，牛车水将变成一个光影与色彩的童话世界，街道上方布满壮观装饰。［与此同时］节庆街市将提供所有传统春节食品和用品，如腊鸭、肉干、各式饼干以及其他新年用品。这里因此成为华人、本地人和游客感受节庆气氛的‘必到之地’。在农历新年前夜（2月6日），鼠年倒数活动将正式开始，成千上万的狂欢者会彻夜庆祝。”60）2009年和2010年春节期间，都有超过200万人到访牛车水。事实上，当时新加坡旅游业正快速增长（2010年游客超过1160万人，是本国人口的两倍多）；在新加坡免费进入的旅游目的地中，牛车水位列前三，与新加坡主要购物大道 Orchard Road 以及历史街区 Little India 并列。61）值得注意的是，牛车水一方面仍然受到西方游客欢迎——2009年尤其包括来自意大利、德国、英国和法国的游客——另一方面也正成为快速增长的中国大陆、台湾和香港游客的重要目的地。62）作为客源市场，中国的重要性增长非常迅速，近年来已成为新加坡第二大游客来源市场；2006年12月19日，新加坡首次迎来年度第100万名中国游客这一里程碑。63）总之，即使来自华人地区的游客在游客数量中日益占据突出位置，新加坡牛车水仍然牢牢保持着作为“旅游凝视”对象的地位。

Conclusion

结论

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 15

Singapore’s Chinatown has gained a place of unquestioned legitimacy both as a heritage artifact within a highly planned urban landscape undergirded by the CMIO multicultural ideology, as well as a leisure and tourism site which generates activities for both tourist and local visitors, and revenue for businesses and the state. Unlike most of the ethnic neighbourhoods located in western cities, Singapore’s Chinatown cannot be described as a hub of ‘immigrant ethnic entrepreneurship’ in the same way. First, Chinatown in Singapore is a landscape created by Chinese immigration under a liberal colonial immigration regime in the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries; it is no longer the receiving area for immigration streams but is remembered and valued as a tribute to the early pioneering immigrants. Second, it has to be understood as an ‘ethnic’ neighbourhood in a very different way, where ‘ethnic’ does not signify ‘minority’ or ‘immigrant’ culture but represents the dominant ‘race’ within the Chinese-Malay- Indian-Other equation characterising the fabric of Singaporean society. Third, unlike the case of migrant residential concentrations in the west, the making of historic district needs to be contextualized within the cultural politics at play between the state and its citizens, as the city-state contemplates pathways of nation-building and heritage tourism. As such, Singapore’s Chinatown is not so much the lynchpin of an alternative ‘ethnic economy’ but instead integral to the cultural politics of national identity as well as significant as a consumption site for heritage tourism selling a mainstream, memorialized ‘ethnic culture’. Finally, it is important to note that struggles over place identities are no longer focused on historic districts such as Chinatown, possibly because it has ceased to be a predominantly residential landscape integral to the everyday realities of the majority of Singaporeans even as it continues its symbolic function as the fount of Chineseness in the popular imagination. As Chinatown becomes more akin to a vision of the “past” which is more like a “foreign country”64), the historic district is no longer part of everyday lived culture but the locus of a cultural politics of nostalgia. The absence of open or organized place politics around Chinatown is congruent with the depoliticization of culture in the city-state and is an indication of the comfortable ways the historic district has been folded into the national imaginary of the multiracial self. As Yeoh Seng Guan notes (drawing on Appadurai’s work), ‘a locality is opportunistically regarded as a site that can either generate national level nostalgia, celebrations and commemorations or as a necessary condition of the production of nationals’.65) By harnessing Chinatown as a representative landscape within the logics of CMIO-multiracialism, the locality is clearly drawn into the work of reproducing compliant national subjects that cohere with state philosophy. This appears in sharp contrast to other contexts such as in Auckland, where a group of 1.5 generation and New Zealand-born Chinese conducted a very public and sophisticated “No Chinatown” campaign (aimed primarily at resisting what they saw as essentialising Chineseness in disadvantageous if not dangerous ways) when a local authority started toying with the idea of establishing a Chinatown in the city.66) Chinatown’s place is also anchored by tourist dollars and the ethnic precinct looks to enlarging its role in Singapore’s tourism game plans given the rapidly growing and lucrative China outbound market fuelled by the emergence in Chinese cities of a large middle class with strong consumption power.67)

□□□□ · □□□□ **15**

新加坡牛车水已经获得一种几乎不受质疑的正当位置：它既是在 CMIO 多元文化意识形态支撑下、高度规划城市景观中的遗产对象，也是一个为游客和本地访客提供活动、并为企业和国家创造收入的休闲旅游地点。与西方城市中的大多数族群社区不同，新加坡牛车水不能以同样方式被描述为“移民族群创业”的中心。第一，新加坡牛车水是在19世纪与20世纪初相对自由的殖民移民制度下，由华人移民创造出来的景观；今天它已不再是新一轮移民的接纳区，而是作为对早期开拓移民的纪念而被记忆和珍视。第二，必须以一种非常不同的方式理解它的“族群”社区属性：这里的“族群”并不意味着“少数群体”或“移民”文化，而是代表构成新加坡社会基本结构的“华人—马来人—印度人—其他”公式中的主导“种族”。第三，与西方移民居住聚集区不同，历史街区的形成需要置于国家与公民之间运作的文化政治中加以理解，因为这个城市国家正在思考国家建构与遗产旅游的发展路径。因此，新加坡牛车水与其说是另一种“族群经济”的关键支点，不如说是国家认同文化政治不可分割的一部分；与此同时，它也是遗产旅游的重要消费场所，出售的是一种被纪念化并已进入主流的“族群文化”。最后，值得注意的是，围绕地方身份的斗争如今已经不再集中于牛车水这样的历史街区。这可能是因为，尽管牛车水在大众想象中继续发挥着“华人性源头”的象征功能，它已经不再是一个以居住为主、并深入多数新加坡人日常现实的景观。随着牛车水越来越接近一种“过去”的图景，而这个“过去”更像一个“异国”64)，历史街区便不再属于日常生活文化，而成为怀旧文化政治的场所。围绕牛车水缺少公开或有组织的地方政治，与城市国家中文化去政治化的现象相一致，也表明这个历史街区已经以相当顺畅的方式被纳入国家对于“多种族自我”的想象。正如 Yeoh Seng Guan 借用 Appadurai 的观点所指出的，“地方被机会主义地视为一种地点：它既可以制造国家层面的怀旧、庆典和纪念，也可以成为生产国民所必需的条件”。65)
通过把牛车水作为 CMIO 多种族主义逻辑中的代表性景观来运用，这一地方显然被纳入了再生产顺从国家哲学之国民主体的工作。这与其他情境形成鲜明对比，例如在 Auckland，当地政府开始考虑在城市中建立 Chinatown 时，一群“1.5代”和新西兰出生的华人发起了公开且非常成熟的“No Chinatown”运动；他们主要是为了抵抗自己所认为的、会以不利甚至危险方式把“华人性”本质化的做法。66）牛车水的地位也由旅游收入所支撑；随着中国城市中具有强大消费能力的中产阶级出现，中国出境旅游市场迅速扩大且利润丰厚，这一族群街区也希望在新加坡旅游发展规划中扮演更大角色。67）

ENGLISH ORIGINAL · Reading unit 16

This of course does not spell the end of the cultural politics of encounter in the city-state. Current negotiations over the meanings of multiethnicity are concentrated at other newly emerging sites of contestation within Singapore’s rapidly evolving transnational ethnoscapes. In a ‘cosmopolitan’ city where over a third of the population of five million at the end of the first decade of the new millennium do not belong to the “CMIO citizen-races”, the cultural politics of race, class and nationality are now most intense in the contact zones where Singapore citizens encounter foreign others, including ‘weekend enclaves’ of foreign workers68), residential heartlands where locals and foreigners live69) and professional or hi-tech workplaces with increasing numbers of expatriate workers70). In this sense, while discourses and practices continue to be negotiated as Singapore attempts to transform itself into a city-state of multiple ethnicities and nationalities, Chinatown as the ethnic precinct par excellence with firm claims to historical legitimacy, revenue productivity and representative value as part of “CMIO-multiculturalism” is no longer controversial.

□□□□ · □□□□ **16**

当然，这并不意味着城市国家中有关“相遇”的文化政治已经终结。当前围绕多族群意义所展开的协商，正集中在新加坡迅速演变的跨国族群景观中其他新出现的争议地点。到新千年第一个十年末，在一个拥有500万人口、其中超过三分之一并不属于“CMIO 公民种族”的“世界都会”里，种族、阶级与国籍的文化政治如今最集中地发生在新加坡公民与外国“他者”相遇的接触区，包括外国劳工的“周末飞地”68)、本地人与外国人共同居住的住宅社区69)，以及外籍工作人员数量不断增加的专业或高科技工作场所70)。从这个意义上说，在新加坡试图把自身转变为一个拥有多重族群和多重国籍的城市国家时，相关话语和实践仍在持续协商；但牛车水作为最典型的族群街区，凭借其对历史正当性的稳固主张、创造收入的能力，以及作为“CMIO 多元文化主义”组成部分的代表价值，已经不再具有争议性。

References

参考文献（保留英文，不翻译）

The bibliographic list below is retained in English so that names, titles, publication details and page numbers stay as they appear in the source.

> 以下书目保留英文，便于准确记录作者姓名、题名、出版信息和页码。

Anderson, K. J. “The idea of Chinatown: the power of place and institutional practice in the making of a racial category” Annals of the Association of American Geographers 77, no. 4 (1987): 580-98.

Benton, G. and Gomez, E. T. “Essentializing Chinese identity: transnationalism and the Chinese in Europe and Southeast Asia.” Approaching

Transnationalism, ed. B.S.A. Yeoh, M.W. Charney and C.K. Tong. 251-300. Dordrecht: Kluwer Academic Publishers, 2003.

Burton, S. “History with a bottom line” Time, 12 July (1993): 36-37.

Chang, T. C. “Heritage as a tourism commodity: Traversing the tourist-local divide” Singapore Journal of Tropical Geography 18 (1997): 46-68.

Chang, T. C. “Singapore's Little India: A Tourist Attraction as a Contested Landscape” Urban Studies 37, no. 2 (2000): 343-366.

Chang, T. C., Milne, S., Fallon, D. and Pohlmann, C. “Urban heritage tourism: The global-local nexus” Annals of Tourism Research 23